



Welcome! HICMF was founded in 2024 to support an active contemporary music scene in Hamilton. After a successful debut in February 2025, this is the second annual concert.

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Program Notes

Weaving — Chikage Imai

Bio: Chikage Imai <http://www.chikageimai.net> Studying under artists like Yuasa Joji, Matsui Akihiko, Wim Henderickx and Fabio Nieder, Imai graduated with a degree in Composition from the Aichi University of the Arts in 2002 and received her master's degree at the Conservatorium van Amsterdam in 2009. Her works have been commissioned by variable organizations and musicians from all over the world such as Festival d'Automne à Paris, Westdeutscher Rundfunk, Music from Japan, Hanatsu~miroir, Vertixe Sonora Ensemble, Tosiya Suzuki and so on.

In her compositions, Imai regards music as an organism and explores her concept “vector in music” to expand its sensory possibilities. Her artistic practice has led Imai to engage in and direct various interdisciplinary projects that deepened her connection with visual art, photography, contemporary dance and scenography. In recent years, Imai's strong interest in “a close coexistence between art and society” has led her to organize a lecture and concert series entitled “Crossboundary”, as well as the Contemporary Music Academy, to further establish the contemporary music scene in Nagoya. These projects opened up opportunities to participate in locally-rooted projects and

events including Nakagawa Canal Project - ARToC10 and Aichi Triennale 2016, 2019 (Open Competition for Stage Performance), among others. In 2020 Imai was offered to write a short piece for a big chamber ensemble piece for the 40th anniversary of Ensemble Modern as only one Japanese composer after master composers like Ennio Morricone and Helmut Lachenmann. Her interdisciplinary work with photography and visual art “Synecdochism III” was created for Aichi Triennale 2022 and received a lot of praise from people who are not only involved in contemporary music but also contemporary art. Moreover, in the winter of 2023, a commissioned work “Starry Bulges for 21 musicians” celebrating the 20th anniversary of the International Ensemble Modern Academy premiered and received high praise. Imai’s music is published Muzikproduktion Dabringhaus und Grimm and Ensemble Modern Media. Through being an honorary research associate at Royal Holloway, University of London, she is currently an artistic director of Seainx project.

Verde Malachite — Chikako Iversen

Percussion duo with saxophone. The ensemble creates a line of the color over a bed of green. Malachite green has such depth to connect to the center of being. Setting go, setting off, going up high and low and yet all within the depth of green, we find the center of the circle.

[Bio: Chikako Iversen](#)

Entrance — Stephen Morris

[Bio: Stephen Morris](#)

Dark Night Above the Woods — Michael Blazek (2025 Finalist)

The piece evokes the atmosphere of a nocturnal forest, its silence, concealed life, and sudden bursts of movement. It unfolds in four movements.

Originally conceived for five instruments, including accordion, the work was later adapted to fit the instrumentation of the HICMF ensemble. In this revised version, the accordion is replaced by strings, and the ensemble is expanded with percussion.

This transformation does more than extend the palette: the addition of percussion intensifies the music's visceral, animalistic energy, bringing out a wilder and more untamed character. Subtle revisions throughout the piece further sharpen its gestures, making the music more immediate and forceful, reinforcing its dark, raw, and organic sound world.

Bio: Michael Blazek is a Slovak-born composer based in Canada. His music is driven by rhythm, unfolding as raw, untamed energy shaped through a distinctive, microtonally inflected sonic language. His work has been presented across Europe and North America, as well as in South Africa at the ISCM World New Music Days.

Sequenza VIIb — Luciano Berio

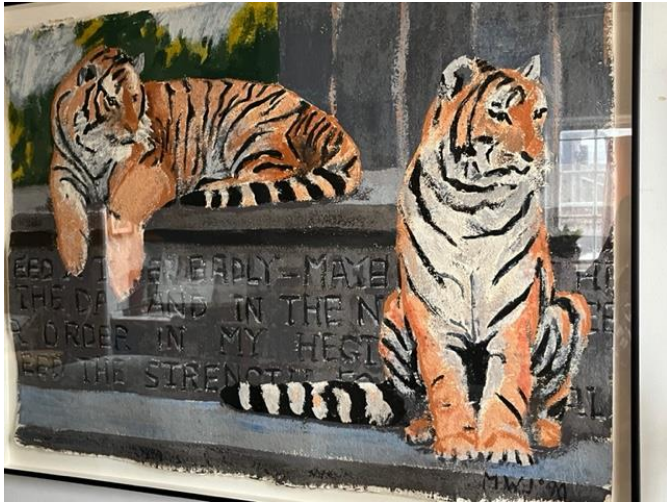
Sequenza VII (composed 1969) is a composition for solo oboe by Luciano Berio, the seventh of his fourteen *Sequenze*. "The Sequenzas are a series of works for sixteen different solo instruments, including trombone, violin, voice, piano, guitar and accordion, are some of Berio's most famous works. All share a common virtuosic element and are "intended to set out and to develop melodically an essentially harmonic discourse and... a polyphonic mode of listening." Sequenza VII was originally written in 1969 for the oboist Heinz

Holliger and was transcribed for soprano saxophone by the composer and Claude Delangle in 1993. Berio has come to prefer this version and had planned to rewrite the oboe version with the effects of the soprano saxophone in mind.

Sequenza VIIIb could be perceived as a variation on one note, B natural. This pitch sounds quietly through the whole piece from another instrument or synthesizer in order to "lend a weak echo to the solo instrument." From the starting pitch, B, an almost complete chromatic register is gradually introduced. The backbone of the work lies in enharmonic fingerings, multiphonics, articulation, and dynamics. The work can create a truly electrophonic impression.

Bio: Luciano Berio taught at Mills College, Harvard University, and the Juilliard School. From 1973 to 1980 he headed the electroacoustic department of IRCAM in Paris. In 1960 and 1982 he was composer in residence at the Tanglewood Music Center, and in 1993-94 delivered the Norton Lectures at Harvard University. One of the most prolific and influential composers of the late twentieth century, Berio received many commissions, prizes, and honorary degrees, and composed for voice, symphony orchestra, music theater, and solo instruments, as well as exploring electronic and digital processing of sound. He also transcribed and adapted works by composers ranging from Monteverdi to Mahler, and collaborated with major Italian literary figures including Italo Calvino and Umberto Eco.” ([source](#)). Berio passed away in 2003.

Two Tigers — David Jaeger



This work is a short set of double variations. The theme is made up of 2 phrases, one chromatic and one diatonic. The variations are alternatively based on these contrasting phrases. This process parallels an image by the late Toronto artist, Milton Jewell. In Jewell's painting, two tigers are resting on a proscenium, their gazes distant and self-

absorbed, as if lost in reflection. In musical terms, I think of each variation as a depiction of the private musings of the two creatures, which often turn out to be less than ferocious.

Bio: David Jaeger

The Machine, The Heart — Boya Liu (Call for Scores Finalist)

“The Machine, the Heart” explores the complex and multilayered relationship between the mechanical and the human heart. The machine is often perceived as a symbol of coldness, precision, and detachment, while the “heart” represents warmth, emotion, and life. Yet in the contemporary context, this boundary has become increasingly blurred: machines can respond to humans with patience and gentleness, while collective human behavior often reveals a programmed, unconscious indifference.

The work does not portray a binary opposition or a transformation between the two; instead, it seeks meaning in their coexistence. Warmth is concealed within mechanical order, and traces of structure and algorithm are embedded within emotional flow. The clarinet and string quartet mirror one another and exchange identities—humanized sonorities may emerge from the “mechanical,” while gentle resonance may arise from the “programmed.” At the core of the music lies the conjunction “and”: the machine and the heart are not separated poles, but mutually dependent, co-breathing entities.

Within this framework, the work positions two extremes in its notation practice: the precise, New-Complexity-inspired writing and the non-metrical, improvisatory notation, symbolizing radical order and radical disorder. At the same time, the clarinet and string quartet form another field of contrasting yet interdependent energies: one embodying mechanical and systematic forces, the other pointing toward the organic, the breathing, and the living. Their interaction does not aim for opposition, but allows these seemingly conflicting forces to penetrate and coexist within the sound.



Bio: Boya Liu (b. 1999, Tangshan, China) is a composer, clarinetist, and music theorist. He completed his undergraduate studies in clarinet performance at the Tianjin Conservatory of Music in 2021, where he also began studying composition and music theory. During his studies, he performed with the Tianjin Symphony Orchestra under the baton of Muhai Tang.

He is currently pursuing a master’s degree in Music Theory and Composition at the Central Conservatory of Music in Beijing, studying counterpoint with Professor Fayong Liang. From 2024 to 2025, he continued his composition studies at the Royal Conservatoire of Scotland with Bekah Simms.

His compositional work focuses on the exploration of timbre and texture as primary structural elements. Rather than relying on traditional melodic or harmonic development, his music often develops through the transformation,

layering, and interaction of sonic materials, with particular attention to density, resonance, and the perceptual shaping of sound.

Liu's works have been performed in China and internationally by ensembles including the Beijing Modern Chamber Ensemble and Ensemble L'Itinéraire. His music has received awards in a number of national and international competitions, including Second Prize in the Toyama International Contemporary Music Festival Opening Composition Competition (Japan), recognition in the 11th ConTempo Composition Competition, and awards from the 20th SunRiver New Music Competition, among others.

In addition to his compositional practice, Liu has presented research on 20th-century polyphony at international academic conferences, reflecting an ongoing engagement with both creative and theoretical approaches to contemporary music.

Turbulence — Tianci Lu (Call for Scores Finalist)



Bio: Tianci Lu's musical journey began as a classical pianist, then as a composer. Her forays into the music profession truly began upon her graduation from the Shanghai Conservatory of Music in 2020, where she had double major in both composition and composition for screen. Seeking to learn more about developing a stronger understanding of jazz to supplement her own works, Tianci then earned a Master's in

Jazz piano at the California Institute of the Arts. Tianci currently is pursuing her doctoral degree in music composition at Princeton University. Tianci has immense versatility in genres, and utilizes her skillsets in a wide variety of styles to creatively construct creative scores and melodies from the stories and feelings that she wishes to sonically portray. She loves to combine multiple

genres of music in synchronous ways, fusing ideas from separate parts to yield cohesive results.

A Vertical Dream — Mehrdad Jafari Raad (Call for Scores Finalist)

What kind of world does the mind build while we sleep? Dreaming is experience, not a remembered story or a symbolic code. It's a state in which we feel ourselves present in a world, complete with sensory presence, spatial depth, and lived immersion.

A Vertical Dream comes from my interest in this world-like quality. For me, dreams aren't puzzles to interpret, but shifting spaces, unstable and continuously transforming with no clear resolution.

Within my dreams, horizons feel limiting. Flat openness closes down the imagination. What pulls me forward is verticality, of moving through spaces that hide as much as they reveal. This impulse shapes the music. Drones establish a ground, while repeating ascending figures create lift and tension. Solo gestures surface briefly, then dissolve back into the texture.

This is not music about a dream. It is an invitation to step inside one, and to listen as its space slowly takes form.



Bio: Mehrdad Jafari Raad is a Toronto-based composer, performer, and media artist whose work spans concert music, film scoring, and electronic and electroacoustic practices. He holds a Doctor of Musical Arts in Composition from the University of Toronto. His music draws on traditional Iranian music alongside other musical traditions encountered through his studies, engaging contemporary classical idioms through a nuanced, narrative-driven approach.

His concert works have been performed internationally and have received numerous awards, and he has collaborated with a wide range of ensembles and performers, including the Bedford Trio, Rogue Duo, and the Brooklyn Chamber Orchestra. Alongside his concert practice, his film scores have been featured at major international festivals such as TIFF, VIFF, and San Sebastián.

In parallel with his work for the concert hall and screen, he collaborates with visual artists on interdisciplinary projects that explore multimodal forms and hybrid performance practices. His current work focuses on creating dialogues between sound and image, structure and improvisation. Across his practice, he engages themes of identity and fragmentation, cultural synthesis, power and resistance, and inner psychological landscapes.

HICMF Artistic Team

Chikako Iversen, *HICMF Producer*



As a freelance conductor, composer and flutist, Chikako has extensively promoted new music, for nine years producing the Depicted Vibrations concert series ([click here](#)) in San Diego California featuring the works of the current composers and notable performers. Recently, Chikako founded and produced the Toyama International Contemporary Music Festival

(TICMF, [click here](#)) in Japan and began the Hamilton International Contemporary Music Festival (HICMF Ontario, [click here](#)) in 2025, featuring an international call for scores competition. HICMF features international premieres in a showcase of new voices in contemporary music. It celebrates international collaborations, and the power of contemporary music to connect both audiences and artists across borders.

See: <https://www.chikakoiversen.org/about>

Stephen Morris, *HICMF Co-Producer*



Stephen Morris is a North Carolina-based composer whose music explores atmospheric, immersive, and trance-like sound worlds. His works have been performed internationally at venues and institutions including Carnegie Hall, Arizona State University, New York University, Seoul National University, the Royal Conservatory of Music, Chateau de Fontainebleau, Trojhalí Karolina, New Holland Island, and the University of North Carolina Greensboro.

Morris has collaborated with a wide range of ensembles and artists, including the Prague Philharmonia, Imani Winds, Moscow Contemporary Ensemble,

Hanzhi Wang, Studio for New Music Ensemble, Li-Chin Li, Gemini Duo, Hypercube, the Brooklyn Chamber Orchestra, and the Lincoln Center Theater Directors Lab. His music has also been featured at festivals and institutes such as Ostrava Days, Écoles d'art américaines de Fontainebleau, Impuls, reMusik, Don't Sleep in Yancheng, the Scarborough Philharmonic Festival, the Imani Winds Chamber Music Festival, Charlotte New Music Festival, Music at the Close, and the SCI Regional Conference.

A winner of the Karen Kieser Prize in Canadian Music, Morris has studied with Huang Ruo and Reiko Fütting, and has participated in lessons and master classes with leading composers including Tristan Murail, George Lewis, Christian Wolff, Bernhard Lang, Bright Sheng, Ana Sokolovic, and Zosha Di Castri. He holds a Doctor of Musical Arts degree from the University of Toronto and a Master of Music degree from Mannes School of Music. He currently serves on the composition faculty at the University of North Carolina Charlotte.

See: <https://www.stephenmorrismusic.org/>

David Jaeger, C.M., *HICMF Artistic Advisor*



David Jaeger is a music producer, composer and broadcaster, who created "Two New Hours", an important contemporary music series in Canada which was heard on the national CBC Radio Two network from 1978 to 2007. During that time he commissioned over 250 original musical works for presentation on air, and broadcast more than 3,000 world premiere performances.

From 1974 to 2002 he served as the CBC Radio coordinator of the CBC/Radio-Canada National Radio Competition for Young Composers, encouraging the establishment of a new wave of Canadian composers.

In 2002 Jaeger was elected President of the International Rostrum of Composers, and was the only non-European ever to be named to this post. He served as President for six years.

Jaeger's compositions range widely from purely melodic unaccompanied works to chamber music, orchestral works and electronic and mixed media compositions. He is a founding member of the Canadian Electronic Ensemble, a live electronic group that remains active.

David Jaeger was named a member of the Order of Canada in 2018.

See <https://davidjaeger.ca>

Bob Becker, *HICMF Musical Advisor*



Bob Becker is a percussionist, composer, arranger, and founding member of the acclaimed percussion ensemble NEXUS. A graduate of the Eastman School of Music, where he earned bachelor's and master's degrees and the Performer's Certificate, he later pursued postgraduate study in world music at Wesleyan University, focusing on the music of India, Africa, and Indonesia. Becker's career spans orchestral, chamber, contemporary, world, and solo percussion traditions. He has performed with the Marlboro

Festival Orchestra under Pablo Casals, the Paul Winter Consort, Tafelmusik Baroque Orchestra, Ensemble Intercontemporaine, Ensemble Modern, and many major symphony orchestras. Since 1973, he has also been a member of Steve Reich and Musicians, contributing to landmark performances and recordings, including the Grammy-winning *Music for 18 Musicians*.

Internationally recognized as a leading xylophone and marimba virtuoso, Becker has helped revive early 20th-century xylophone repertoire and performance practice. His work with NEXUS has taken him around the world and earned honors including induction into the Percussive Arts Society Hall of Fame. He has studied and performed extensively in West African and North Indian musical traditions, including tabla study with Pandit Sharda Sahai.

As a composer, Becker's works and arrangements are performed worldwide and published by Keyboard Percussion Publications. His compositions include *There is a Time*, *Music On The Moon*, *Turning Point*, *Preludes*, and *Water Lilies*. He has also collaborated with dance companies, lectured internationally, designed instruments and mallets with Mallettech and Sabian, and authored *Rudimental Arithmetic*, a study of snare drum rudiments, composition, and polyrhythmic theory.

See: <https://www.nexuspercussion.com/members/bob-becker-bio/>

Call for Score Judges

HICMF annually hosts an international call for scores. Three selected compositions are showcased at the annual concert.



Gary Kulesha

University of
Toronto

Stephen Morris

University of
N.C. Charlotte

Joe Lio

China
Conservatory
of Music

Chikako Iversen

HICMF and
TICMF Founder

HICMF Ensemble

Katie Kirkpatrick, *flute*



Born and raised in Timmins, Ontario, flutist Katie Kirkpatrick is a Toronto-based performer with a growing focus on contemporary music. As a soloist, chamber musician, orchestral player, and recording artist, she has performed across Canada and Europe, including a chamber residency at the Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity with Magali Mosnier, Paul

Meyer, and Éric Le Sage, the Scotland Flute School with Ian Clarke, and the Domaine Forget Intensive and Chamber Orchestra program with Emmanuel Pahud and Julien Beaudiment. This summer, she will attend soundSCAPE, a highly regarded contemporary music program in Switzerland with Lisa Cella.

Katie has been a proud member of the University of Toronto's Contemporary Music Ensemble for two years, working with Wallace Halladay and performing works by Unsuk Chin, Thomas Adès, Sofia Gubaidulina, and Vivian Fung. She approaches this repertoire with curiosity and openness, with experience on piccolo, flute, alto flute, bass flute, and even slide whistle.

Her recent recording work includes a collaboration with the Canadian Music Centre on Clés, and an upcoming project dedicated to the chamber music of Jeff Smallman. Katie completed her undergraduate studies at Western University and is currently completing a Master of Music at the University of Toronto.

Kailan Fournier, *clarinet*



Kailan Fournier is a freelance clarinetist based in Toronto. As an orchestral freelancer, Kailan has performed with ensembles such as Les Violons du Roy, the Ontario Philharmonic, Hamilton Philharmonic, the Syracuse Symphony Orchestra and various others. Kailan completed his Bachelor's degree at The Glenn Gould School with Joaquin Valdepeñas, a Graduate degree at McGill University with Todd Cope and recently finished his Advanced Diploma in Performance at the Eastman School of Music with Michael Wayne. With a recently developing interest in new music, Kailan is excited to begin exploring more contemporary repertoire and the bizarre and exciting extended techniques that are possible on the clarinet. In his spare time, Kailan also manages a cafe in Yorkville and enjoys rock climbing.

Christopher Jones, *saxophone*



Christopher Jones is a saxophonist, educator, and advocate for new music. Enthusiastic about working with composers, he regularly performs premieres with a variety of ensembles including the Toronto Saxophone Collective and Resonant Threads Collective. He has placed highly in the Andorra Saxfest International Solo Competition, New York

International Classical Music Competition, Canadian Music Competition, and University of Toronto's Winds Concerto Competitions. Recent performance highlights include appearances with the New Symphony Orchestra, National Ballet of Canada, University of Toronto New Music Festival, Kingston Symphony, and the University of Toronto Contemporary Music Ensemble. Christopher teaches a private studio and holds degrees from the University of Toronto. When he's not playing or teaching, you might find him stargazing.

Diane Dahyeon Kim, *violin*



Diane Dahyeon Kim is a Korean-Canadian violinist who is actively performing worldwide. She was part of the National Youth Orchestra in 2022 and 2023 where she received the Stephen Sitariski Leadership Award and served as a Co-Concertmaster. In 2019, she was a member of the Schleswig-Holstein Musik Festival and was also a substitute violinist at the Millenium Symphony in Seoul, South Korea, the SFK Euro Symphony and the Kärnten Symphony Orchester in Klagenfurt, Austria. She is currently a substitute member of Sinfonia Toronto and Ontario Philharmonic, and Windsor Symphony.

Diane was a student at the Phil and Eli Taylor Academy in the Royal Conservatory of Music and a member of the Toronto Symphony Youth Orchestra for four years, serving as Co-Concertmaster. She graduated from the Glenn Gould School's Bachelor of Music program, studying under Paul Kantor and Barry Shiffman. She received her master's degree at the Gustav Mahler Privat Universität, studying under Sae Won Suh. Currently, she is pursuing an Artist Diploma program at the Glenn Gould School under Min-Jeong Koh and Marie Berard. She is also a viola/viola mentor at the Oscar Peterson Program and actively teaches privately and as a faculty member at the Musical Arts Academy.

Veronica Zupanic, *violin*



Veronica Zupanic is a Toronto-based violinist specializing in contemporary music and interdisciplinary collaboration. Her work focuses on new repertoire, experimental performance practices, and the exploration of tuning and intonation. She has given Canadian premieres of works by Liza Lim and

Unsub Chin and performed Cassandra Miller's For Mira at the soundSCAPE Festival in Italy.

As concertmaster of the University of Toronto Contemporary Music Ensemble, she worked closely with composers including Francisco Coll, Donnacha Dennehy, Zosha di Castri, Magnus Lindberg, and Ana Sokolović. Her performance interests include microtonal and exploratory repertoire, including works such as Giacinto Scelsi's L'Âme Ailée / L'Âme Ouverte.

Veronica is the violinist of Resonant Threads Sound Collective and the founding violinist of vox & bow, a duo with vocalist Lindsay McIntyre dedicated to immersive contemporary performance. Their inaugural project, a performance of György Kurtág's Kafka Fragments, was presented at Array Space in Toronto.

She holds a Bachelor of Music from the University of Ottawa, where she studied with Yehonatan Berick, and a Master of Music from the University of Toronto under Mark Fewer.

Marlena Pellegrino, *violin, viola*



Canadian violist Marlena Pellegrino is a versatile and curious musician whose artistic practice lies at the intersection of composer/performer collaboration, improvised sound, and interdisciplinary exploration. An avid traveler, Marlena has performed at festivals across North America and Europe, including the International Festival of the Adriatic, Labo de Musique Contemporaine de Montréal, Mostly Modern Festival among others. Between 2023 and 2024, Marlena performed with the Next Festival of Emerging Artists, premiering and recording works for string orchestra and collaborating with artists such as Curtis Stewart, Seth Parker Woods, and Yvette Young. Marlena has been the recipient of numerous awards, including

the Gaston Héon Graduate Scholarship in Music, the Nalini Perera Little Lotus Scholarship, and the 2022 NUMUS Emerging Curator Award. She has appeared on multiple recordings across a wide range of genres from classical to popular, folk and spoken word. Currently based in Toronto, Marlana maintains a busy private teaching studio and an active performance schedule. Alongside her teaching and performance work, she serves as the New Music Coordinator for the Toronto Symphony Orchestra where she helps to facilitate the planning and realization of new orchestral commissions.

Chloe Liang, *cello*



Born in Taipei, Taiwan, Chloe Liang is a Toronto-based cellist currently pursuing a Bachelor's degree in Music Performance at the University of Toronto, alongside studies in human biology. Her musical journey began on the piano at age six before turning to the cello at ten, drawn to its expressive range and versatility. With a broad repertoire spanning classical and contemporary works, she is dedicated to both solo and ensemble performance.

As an orchestral and chamber musician, Chloe has performed with ensembles including the Toronto Symphony Youth Orchestra, University of Toronto Symphony Orchestra, Toronto Chamber Symphony, and the Scarborough Philharmonic Orchestra, and has also appeared with the Contemporary Music Ensemble. Her work has been recognized through several awards from the University of Toronto, including the Kathryn Jean Poole In-course Scholar Award and the Gregor Piatigorsky Memorial Award in Cello (2025), as well as the Jean Chalmers Award (2024), the Susan Cale Award (2023), and the University of Toronto Scholar Award (2022).

Chloe has studied with esteemed teachers Chien-An Chen, Chih-Yin Wei, Joseph Johnson, and Paul Widner, and has participated in masterclasses with

internationally renowned cellists Johannes Moser, Jean-Guihen Queyras, and Shauna Rolston.

Nikki Huang, *percussion*



Nikki Huang is a Taiwanese percussionist based in Toronto, whose work moves fluidly between contemporary performance, storytelling, and interdisciplinary collaboration. She is drawn to music that explores character and narrative, often working across original compositions, jazz vibraphone, children's musical theatre, and workshop-based practices. Her artistic approach is shaped by a deep interest in collaboration and performance as a shared, imaginative space.

As an active performer, Huang has collaborated with ensembles and artists including Esprit Orchestra, New Music Concerts, Women From Space, The Happenstancers, Coexistdance, and Ensemble Intercontemporain through the ULYSSES Platform for Young Musicians. She was selected as an artist of HappLab 2025, and has held artist residencies at the Banff Centre and the Westben Centre. Huang holds a master's degree in Percussion Performance from the University of Toronto, where she also worked as a research assistant in the Technology and Performance Integration Lab.

For more information about Nikki Huang, please visit

<https://nikkihuang.weebly.com/>

Bevis Ng, *percussion*



Originally from Hong Kong, Bevis Ng is a Toronto-based percussionist specializing in contemporary classical music. He is currently completing a Doctor of Musical Arts in Percussion Performance at the University of Toronto, supported by the Ontario Graduate Scholarship and the Terence Clarkson and Cornelis van de Graaff Graduate

Scholarship. His doctoral research examines rehearsal processes in percussion chamber music.

A passionate chamber musician, Bevis founded two Toronto-based ensembles: KÖNG Duo with percussionist Hoi Tong Keung, and Kairos Percussion Quartet, whose members include Andrew Busch, Nikki Huang, and Thomas Li. The award-winning KÖNG Duo has performed widely in Canada and internationally, with appearances in Darmstadt (Germany), Portland (USA), and Eindhoven (The Netherlands), and is an Ensemble Artist with Marimba One. Since its formation in 2023, Kairos Percussion Quartet has performed across Canada at venues including the Aga Khan Museum, the Toronto Music Garden, McGill University, the University of Windsor, and Arcadia University. In 2024, the quartet was featured as the solo ensemble in Kevin Lau's "Charon's Dance" with the University of Toronto Wind Symphony.

Committed to thoughtful programming and close collaboration with composers, Bevis seeks to create engaging concert experiences that make contemporary music more accessible. His co-curated KÖNG Duo project "good morning, hong kong" combines video, lighting, voice, and music to explore memory, nostalgia, and the experience of longing for home.

Sae Hae Bae, *piano* (friendly appearance on *Entrance*, by Steven Morris)

Sae Hae Bae is a Toronto-based pianist, composer, and educator. A recipient of numerous prizes and scholarships at prestigious institutions, she pursued her studies at the Eastman School of Music, the University of Toronto, and the Glenn Gould School. She was consistently recognized for her academic excellence, earning a place on the Dean's List and receiving awards such as the Dean's Scholarship, the Women's Art Association of Canada Scholarship, the University of Toronto Music Award, and the Margaret Parsons-Poole and Clifford Poole Scholarship.

She regularly performs solo and chamber recitals across Canada, the United States, Italy, France, and South Korea. Her performance venues include Kilbourn Hall, MacMillan Theatre, Studley Theatre, The Port Theatre, Jardin de l'Ange, Château de Fontainebleau, Cité Internationale Universitaire de Paris, the Four Seasons Hotel Seoul, and Carnegie Weill Recital Hall.

Sae Hae currently works as a collaborative pianist at the University of Toronto and the Glenn Gould School, and maintains a private studio in Toronto.